

0.0.1 The Nigantha

0. Source: Vesali.

1. At one time, the venerable Ananda was dwelling at Vesali in the Great Wood, at the Hall with the Peaked Roof. Then Abhaya, the Licchavi and Panditakumara, the Licchavi, visited with the venerable Ananda. Upon arrival, having paid respects to the venerable Ananda, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, Abhaya, the Licchavi said this to the venerable Ananda:

2. Nigantha Nataputta, O Bhante, is all knowing and all seeing and acknowledges complete knowledge and vision thus: “Whether I am walking or standing or sleeping or awake, knowledge and vision are continuously and uninterruptedly present to me.” He says thus: “There is for you, O friend Niganthas, evil kamma done in the past. Wear them away by this sharp and gruelling austerities. When you are now restrained by body, restrained by speech and restrained by mind here, that is the non-doing of evil kamma for the future. Thus, by the elimination of past kamma with exertion, and the non-doing of new kamma, [there is] no oozings in the future. From no oozings in the future comes the extinction of kamma. From the extinction of kamma comes the extinction of suffering. From the extinction of suffering comes the extinction of feeling. From the extinction of feeling, all suffering will be worn away?” Thus, this surmounting

by wearing away purification is visible, here and now.

3. “Here, O Bhante, what does the Auspicious One say [about this]?”

4. There are these three wearing away purifications, O Abhaya, rightly declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, for the purification of beings, for the surmounting of sorrow and lamentation, for the subsiding of mental and physical suffering, for the attainment of the know-how, for the realization of nibbana.

5. What three? “Here, O Abhaya, a bhikkhu is virtuous. He dwells restrained by the restraint of the patimokkha, endowed with conduct and resort, seeing danger in the slightest faults. Having undertaken the training rules, he trains in them. He does not do any new kamma and eliminates the old kamma contact after contact. The wearing away is visible here and now, not involving time, inviting witness, leading onwards, to be experienced by the wise for themselves.”

6. That bhikkhu, O Abhaya, thus endowed with virtue, quite secluded from sense-desires, secluded from unwholesome dhammas, he enters upon and abides in the happiness and pleasure born of seclusion connected with thinking and pondering, the first jhana. From the sub-

siding of thinking and pondering, with the internal tranquilization and unification of mind [due to] the absence of thinking and pondering, he enters upon and abides in the happiness and pleasure born of samadhi, the second jhana. With the fading away of happiness, dwelling mindful and contemplative, he looks on with equanimity as he experiences pleasure in the body, of which the Noble Ones say: "He is a mindful one who [looks on with] equanimity, one who dwells in pleasure." He enters upon and abides in the third jhana. From the abandoning of [physical] pleasure and pain, from the extinction of former mental pleasure and mental pain, he enters upon and abides in the utter purity of mindfulness and equanimity without pain and pleasure, the fourth jhana. He does not do any new kamma and eliminates the old kamma contact after contact. The wearing away is visible here and now, not involving time, inviting witness, leading onwards, to be experienced by the wise for themselves."

8. That bhikkhu, O Abhaya, thus endowed with virtue, thus endowed with samadhi, with the extinction of the asavas, having realized for himself with direct knowledge, in this very life, the asava-free mind liberation, wisdom liberation, and having entered upon it, dwells in it. He does not do any new kamma and eliminates the old kamma contact after contact. The wearing away is visible here and now, not involving time, inviting witness, leading onwards, to be experienced by the wise for themselves."

9. These are the three wearing away purifications, O Abhaya, rightly declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened one, for the purification of beings, for the surmounting of sorrow and lamentation, for the subsiding of mental and physical suffering, for the attainment of the know-how, for the realization of nibbana.

10. When thus was said, Panditakumara, the Licchavi, said this to Abhaya, the Licchavi:

11. “But why, O dear Abhaya, do you not rejoice in the venerable Ananda’s well-spoken words?”

12. “Indeed [if] I, O dear, were not to rejoice in the venerable Ananda’s well-spoken words, even my head would split open. For who wouldn’t rejoice in the venerable Ananda’s well-spoken words?”